



1889

IMPERIAL EXPANSION IN AFRICA

European control over Africa grew rapidly as Italy colonized Eritrea and Britain tightened its grip on southern Africa. Expansion was led by speculators such as the controversial imperialist Cecil Rhodes. Granted a charter for his British South Africa Company, he increased British-controlled territory, later named Rhodesia after himself, and extracted mineral rights from leaders, such as King Lobengula of the Ndebele.

◀ Cecil Rhodes as a symbol of imperial greed, *Punch* magazine

**1889 Socialists from
20 countries** meet in
Paris for the Second
International

1889

**1889 Japan adopts the
Meiji constitution,**
which introduces some
political reforms

**1889 American
journalist Nellie Bly**
travels around the
world in 72 days

Between 1913 and 1927, Ford factories
produced more than 15 million Model Ts

1886-1908 EARLY MOTERING

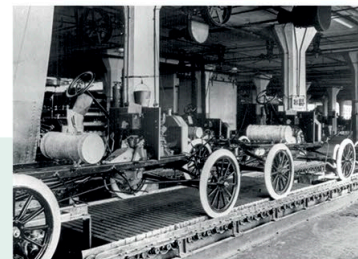


Early motor cars were expensive, but the arrival of mass production in 1908 lowered prices, triggering the age of the automobile.

1886 German engineer Karl Benz patents the first true petrol-powered automobile. With its four-stroke engine and three wire-spoked wheels, it is the first practical car.



1890 Frenchmen René Panhard and Émile Levassor produce the first car with a front-mounted engine. It has rear wheel drive and a sliding gear transmission.



1908 The first Model T-Ford rolls off the production line. Designed and produced by American Henry Ford, it is nicknamed "Tin Lizzie" and is the first mass-produced and affordable car.